

▼ RELATED CAREERS

- ▶ **AEROSPACE ENGINEER** *see pp. 190–191*
- ▶ **AIR TRAFFIC CONTROLLER** *see pp. 216–217*
- ▶ **AIRLINE CABIN CREW** *see pp. 308–309*
- ▶ **HELICOPTER PILOT** Usually flies as the sole pilot, servicing oil platforms, police forces, and rescue teams, and carrying out other survey work. The training required to fly helicopters is costly and intensive. Fewer companies operate helicopters than airplanes, so job opportunities are more scarce.



Pilots train on flight simulators once every year to renew their flying license.

SKILLS GUIDE



An ability to understand and remember technical and procedural information.



Excellent skills in spoken and written English, the international language of the aviation industry.



An ability to remain focused under pressure and to think quickly to resolve problems.



Manual dexterity, sharp eyesight, a good level of physical fitness, and excellent coordination.



Confidence and communication skills to interact with the crew in a calm and efficient manner.

AIRLINE PILOT Major airline pilots fly larger planes on long and short routes. Regional pilots fly smaller planes on shorter routes.



CORPORATE JET PILOT Flies smaller planes, often to smaller airports for private customers.



CARGO PILOT Flies cargo planes, often overnight when airports carry fewer passengers. Shifts are usually fairly predictable, allowing for greater stability in home life.



FIRST OFFICER Shares duties with the captain in flying the plane. After five to ten year's experience, you can progress to captain.



CAPTAIN Following rigorous training and selection, you can become captain, taking overall control of commanding the aircraft.



AIRLINE MANAGER Works as a manager for an airline or for an airport. The job does not involve much time spent in the cockpit.



INSTRUCTOR Trains new pilots on simulators, and works on airline company guidelines.

